

GP-49-HI MAY 1944
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GR-49-HI

MAY, 1944

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RETURN TO
RESEARCH STUDIES
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HISTORICAL DIVISION
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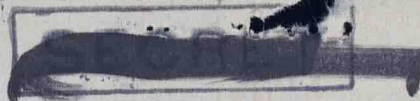
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P.R.C.

DECLASSIFIED
DOD DIR 5200.9

49th Fighter Group
May 1944



GP-49-H1
MAY 44

DESIGNATION SHEET

P.R.C.

AIR FORCE: Fifth Air Force
COMMAND : V Fighter Command
WING :
GROUP : 49th Fighter Group
SQUADRON :

Has security classification been checked? Yes

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DOD DIR 5200.2

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1316-3





1970-1971

1972-1973

1974-1975

1976-1977

1978-1979

1980-1981

1982-1983



HEADQUARTERS 49TH FIGHTER GROUP
ARMY AIR FORCES
APO 920

31 May, 1944.

Group Historical Records (May, 1944)

TO : Commanding General, Fifth Air Force, APO 925.

1. Strength.

a. Personnel, commissioned and enlisted.

	Officers		Enlisted
	Flying	Ground	men
<u>1.</u> At beginning of period	4	16	70
<u>2.</u> Net increase during period	1	3	0
<u>3.</u> Net decrease during period	0	0	3
<u>4.</u> At end of period	5	19	67

2. Aircraft: None with unit.

3. Ground battles engaged in by unit: Nil.

Robert J. Boniece
ROBERT J. BONIECE,
1st Lt., Air Corps,
Historical Officer.

[REDACTED]

HEADQUARTERS 49TH FIGHTER GROUP
ARMY AIR FORCES
APO 920

28 July, 1944.

SUBJECT : May Historical Edition.

TO : Historical Officer, Headquarters, V Fighter Command, APO 713,
Unit 1.

The month of May opened with the 49ers fighting the muck in Finschafen. As usual, excellent plans were drawn up for the forthcoming move. The ground echelon was to leave in two weeks. The first wave with essential camp equipment on a liberty ship and the second on IST's.

The combination of "Stevedore Details" and the striking of camp in false starts did little to help the moral of the men who were anxious to get into events up Hollandia way.

However, as all well laid plans go, the fine efforts that went into the moving details was for naught. Somehow things became mixed up and instead of the ground echelon landing first and setting up camp for the arrival of the air echelon it was the opposite. The air echelon landed first. They faced the task of setting up their own camp and operating "upstairs" at the same time.

While the air echelon was operating from Cyclops strip and setting up camp, the ground echelon was on board the "David S. Barry" and IST's. Living conditions aboard were very poor. The men who couldn't be crammed into the holds were sleeping on deck. We had to furnish our own rations which were eaten cold except when the ships cooks broke down and allowed our men to use the ships kitchen.

On the 13th of May the ground echelon reached Humbolt Bay. The usual "Sweating out" took place and we did not begin to unload until the 17th of May. Because transportation facilities were nil we could not get to the air strip to join the struggling air echelon. A temporary camp was set up while we awaited transportation.

The beach itself was covered with debris and Jap ammunition. In order to make room for unloading ships bulldozers pushed everything aside not bothering to unfuse bombs or duds. A fire got out of control that night. It quickly spread to the ammunition and numerous explosions occurred which threatened to wipe out everything on the beach. We lost one man, two weapons carriers and much equipment. We all felt bitter about this "Beach Party" feeling that better supervision of the beach would have prevented it.

[REDACTED]

Becoming tired of sweating out transportation and jittery about remaining on the jinx beach many of the men started walking to the airstrip bumming rides on the way.

On the 14th of May, 1st Lt. Jacob Shelman and 1st Lt. Robert J. Boniece joined headquarters. I was given the job of Historical Officer and given the task of writing up events which occurred months past. Digging up authentic information became the principle task. The Group Diary was some help but eyewitnesses of past events were either back in the States or transferred. As time passes however, more sources of information are being uncovered. This along with the fact that the Historian is now writing about events which he himself witnesses will lead to constantly improving 49th Group Historical Reports.

The final campsite was located near a cool fast stream which was considered a luxury. The wreckage of Jap planes littered the ground and made a pleasing sight. The men took advantage of the brief respite at Hollandia to rest up and prepare for the forthcoming move to Biak.

From a strategic standpoint our operations from Hollandia were confined to escort missions to Biak. Our fighters covered the Biak landing but little enemy opposition was encountered. More luck was encountered at Manokwari when four definites and one probable were chalked up, by the 9th Squadron. The 7th Squadron increased their score with 13 definites and two probables for the month of May. The 8th Squadron finished with two definites during the month. This closed the month with a total of 19 Nip planes destroyed.

The reconstruction of a wrecked Oscar Mark II was a project engaged in by the 8th Squadron. It was not completed by the end of May but all were anxious to get the plane in the air to see what it could do in the hands of an American pilot.

The last night of May found us again prepared for moving to Biak.

Robert J. Boniece
ROBERT J. BONIECE,
1st Lt Air Corps
Group Historical Officer

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